PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Azure Security Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel | Defender XDR | Cloud Security Architecture

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Azure Security Engineer with over five years of hands-on experience across Azure security engineering, Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR), and hybrid enterprise security operations. I bring deep expertise in securing Infrastructure as a Service (IaaS), Platform as a Service (PaaS), and hybrid environments, including Microsoft Entra ID identity governance, Defender for Cloud, Conditional Access, and cloud security architecture. At the University of the Arts London (UAL) I have led enterprise security engineering across an 8,000-user hybrid estate, designing and operating Microsoft Sentinel Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), Defender XDR, and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) automation to detect and respond to threats mapped against the MITRE ATT&CK framework. I bring additional exposure to Amazon Web Services (AWS) security controls and a track record of delivering effective detection engineering, threat hunting, and cloud security governance in complex, multi-platform organisations. I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Azure Security Engineering:** Microsoft Defender for Cloud, Azure Key Vault, Azure Private Link, Azure Firewall policy (familiarity), Azure Arc, Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), Privileged Identity Management (PIM), Conditional Access
- **SIEM and Detection:** Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL), detection rule engineering, MITRE ATT&CK-mapped analytics, CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), Splunk/SPL
- **Defender XDR Platform:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft Defender for Office 365, Microsoft Defender XDR (unified Extended Detection and Response), CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR)
- **Cloud Security Architecture:** Azure security governance, IaaS/PaaS security design, hybrid enterprise security, multi-cloud security (Azure, AWS), zero-trust architecture
- **Identity and Access Management:** Entra ID, MFA, Single Sign-On (SSO), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), role-based access control
- **Automation and SOAR:** Microsoft Sentinel SOAR playbooks, PowerShell scripting, Logic Apps, automated alert triage and enrichment
- **Endpoint and Device Management:** Microsoft Intune, Mobile Device Management (MDM), Mobile Application Management (MAM), Tanium
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Nessus, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Defender Vulnerability Management
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO/IEC 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) — Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 – Present*

- Lead the architecture, deployment, and operational management of Microsoft Sentinel SIEM across a hybrid enterprise environment, writing KQL-based detection rules aligned to MITRE ATT&CK and tuning analytics to reduce false positives.
- Engineer and maintain Defender XDR across the full Microsoft Defender platform (Defender for Endpoint, Defender for Identity, Defender for Office 365), providing unified threat detection and investigation across endpoints, identities, and email.
- Manage Azure security controls including Defender for Cloud, Entra ID Conditional Access, Key Vault, Private Endpoints, and role-based access control, maintaining secure cloud governance across the Azure and Microsoft 365 (M365) estate.

- Oversee CrowdStrike Falcon EDR deployment for endpoint telemetry and threat hunting, leveraging NG-SIEM capabilities to correlate endpoint signals with Azure and M365 security alerts.
- Develop and maintain SOAR automation playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel, automating alert triage, threat enrichment, and incident containment workflows to accelerate mean time to respond (MTTR).
- Conduct proactive threat hunting using Sentinel KQL queries, CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, and Microsoft Defender Advanced Hunting to identify attacker behaviour before automated alerts fire.
- Lead enterprise vulnerability management programmes using Tenable.io and Pentera BAS across cloud workloads, endpoints, and applications, coordinating remediation across infrastructure and application teams.
- Collaborate with network and infrastructure teams on security architecture reviews, advising on Azure Private Link, Conditional Access design, and hybrid connectivity controls.
- Produce security metrics, risk posture reporting, and threat intelligence briefings for senior leadership and governance stakeholders.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) — Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity *March 2022 – March 2025*

- Monitored and investigated security alerts across Microsoft Sentinel, Defender XDR, and CrowdStrike Falcon, responding to incidents using NIST SP 800-61 methodology and documenting findings and lessons learned.
- Administered Entra ID and Conditional Access policies to enforce least-privilege access and zero-trust principles across hybrid and cloud identities, including PIM and privileged account governance.
- Supported configuration and tuning of Defender for Cloud and Azure Policy to maintain security posture visibility and enforce governance controls across Azure resources.
- Performed ongoing vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io, Nessus, and AppCheck, tracking and driving remediation of critical and high-severity findings.
- Managed BeyondTrust PAM to control privileged access to critical infrastructure, applying session recording and least-privilege policies.
- Assisted in delivery of Cyber Essentials Plus certification, aligning endpoint and cloud controls with CIS Controls and ISO/IEC 27001 requirements.
- Authored incident response playbooks and security runbooks to standardise analyst response procedures across the security operations team.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) — IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure *February 2021 – March 2022*

- Configured and maintained Azure and M365 security controls for a Software as a Service (SaaS) FinTech organisation, including Conditional Access, Entra ID governance, Defender for Endpoint, and Intune endpoint management.
- Designed and enforced identity security policies including MFA, SSO integration, and privileged account lifecycle management, reducing identity-based risk exposure.
- Performed vulnerability assessments and managed patching cycles, coordinating remediation with infrastructure teams to maintain a hardened cloud and endpoint estate.
- Supported ISO/IEC 27001 compliance activities including risk assessments, control mapping, and evidence gathering for internal and external audits.
- Responded to and investigated security incidents, conducting root cause analysis and implementing corrective and preventative controls.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Deployed and operationalised the full Microsoft Defender XDR platform across 8,000 users, achieving unified threat detection and response across endpoints, identities, email, and cloud workloads.
- Built a comprehensive library of KQL analytics in Microsoft Sentinel aligned to MITRE ATT&CK, significantly reducing false-positive rates and improving detection fidelity.
- Automated security alert triage and incident enrichment using SOAR playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel, reducing manual analyst effort on common alert types.
- Led enterprise vulnerability management using Tenable.io and Pentera BAS, reducing critical exposure across cloud and endpoint assets through structured remediation coordination.
- Maintained Cyber Essentials Plus certification for UAL, ensuring technical controls across endpoints, firewalls, patch management, and access remained certified and audit-ready.
- Designed zero-trust Conditional Access and Intune compliance policies extending security controls to BYOD and corporate mobile devices across a diverse, multi-platform estate.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)